X-energy, Inc.

XE Continues Commercial Execution, Inking JDA with AEP and Amazon for 960MW

Overweight

XE, XE US
Price (19 Oct 26):$10.54

Head of North America Power, Utilities, Midstream, LNG, and Nuclear

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This morning, **X-energy** and **American Electric Power** announced a Joint Development Agreement (JDA) to study the feasibility of a proposed 960MW, 12-unit Xe-100 small modular reactor (SMR) plant in Sullivan County, Indiana. Amazon plans to support project development through a funding agreement and subsequently purchase the power under a long-term contract. AEP's now-retired coal plant, Breed Generating Station, is the primary location under consideration for the project. We see the announcement as an encouraging signal, following through on 2Q call commentary that pointed to a 1GW announcement by year-end. As the parties progress through feasibility studies, we believe incremental details around firm contracted offtake, financing structure, capex, and licensing timeline could build meaningful investor confidence in the long-term growth outlook.

- **The deal structure answers utility affordability concerns, but the details are still to come.** AEP's CEO said the agreements with Amazon and X-energy provide "all necessary capital protections and financial safeguards" that AEP considers essential for any nuclear project. Amazon said it intends to "pay our full costs without passing them to others." We see hyperscaler development funding, mitigating utilities from first-of-a-kind cost risk, as an attractive structure to support broader SMR deployment. We look for clarity on: (1) the size and milestone triggers of Amazon's funding; (2) whether Amazon will sign a long-term power purchase agreement and on what terms; (3) how costs and risk will be shared once the project moves past feasibility; and (4) the expected construction permit and commercial operation dates. Key risks include unfavorable feasibility work results, JDA or funding terminations, or missed milestones.
- **A 12-unit plant would be a meaningful test of how well the Xe-100 scales.** Each Xe-100 is an 80MWe high-temperature gas-cooled reactor running on TRISO fuel. Because of its intrinsic safety profile, it can be built on a compact footprint closer to where power is needed, and reusing a retired coal site gives the project existing land and transmission. At 12 units, Indiana would be three times the size of the Dow project. If it goes ahead, it should help prove out the cost and schedule savings from repeat builds that underpin X-energy's claim of lower costs and faster construction than other SMRs. It should also support demand for TRISO-X fuel. We see delivery on the Dow project (licensing, then construction) as the gating factor before investors put meaningful value on later projects like Indiana and Cascade.
- **Indiana screens as a strong site candidate.** We view Indiana as a favorable site candidate, having demonstrated a pro-nuclear stance as of late. Governor Mike Braun and the state General Assembly have enacted state policies to support SMR deployment specifically, reflected in available investment and manufacturing tax credits. However, affordability remains topical in the state, raising the question of whether AMZN would completely shield the costs from ratepayers.

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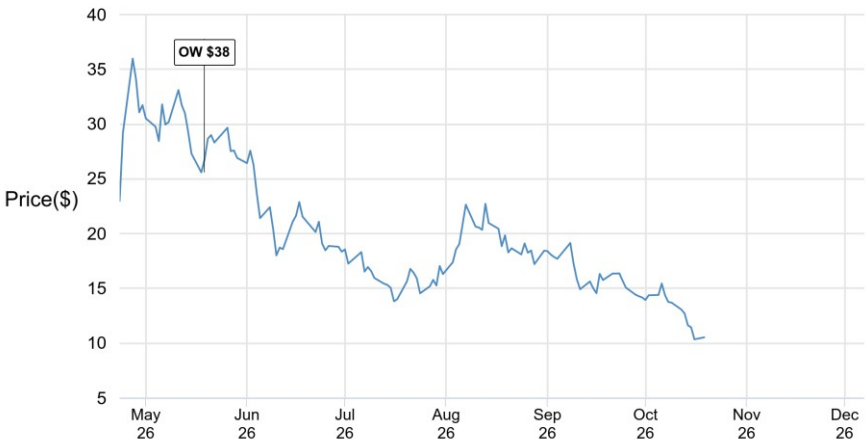
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X-energy, Inc. (XE, XE US) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price ($)	Price Target ($)
19-May-26	OW	25.60	38

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage May 19, 2026. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

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